



Youth Physics Writing Contest

A magazine-style physics writing competition

§ Overview

Youth Physics Writing Contest is a school-level competition where one physics idea becomes a piece of writing people enjoy reading. Students from grades 9 to 12 take a single scientific corner and shape it into a clear, warm, magazine-style article, the way a feature writer would, rather than the way a lab report gets written. Curiosity matters more than prior experience or grades. There is one round, every article is judged once against the same scale, and the strongest pieces end up in a Physics Club Magazine issue.

§ Format

Every article follows the shape of a good magazine feature. It opens with a title that promises something specific, and an introduction that pulls the reader in quickly. The body explains the physics in plain language, written for a curious nonspecialist, and points to where the idea shows up in real life. It closes with an interesting insight and a short, memorable ending.

Length sits between **600 and 1500 words**. Warm, clear language beats jargon, so analogies are welcome and graphs, figures, and GIFs help. A strong article usually holds one central idea instead of three small ones, and numbers are used honestly and checked twice. AI-generated text is not accepted; the writing has to be the student's own.

§ Topics

Writers begin with a scientific desk and then find the human story inside it. A student might ask why a phone flashlight looks blue in the dark, how one wave can silence another, or what a black hole really is. The six desks below accept that kind of question: the night sky, from the phases of the Moon to the edges of the galaxy; the hidden mechanics of electricity and magnetism, from a fridge magnet to a power grid; sound and waves, from ripples in a glass to noise-cancelling headphones; a honest, careful simplification of modern and quantum physics; thermodynamics, from a cooling cup of tea to a large engine; and the physics quietly hiding in daily life.

§ Timeline

Submissions arrive through the contest page as a Word or PDF file, alongside an optional GIF. The form records the student's name, school, chosen topic, and the exact submission time, and no edits are accepted once registration closes. The dates look like this:



Registration opens	September 4
Registration closes	September 30
Judging	October 1 to October 10
Results and medals	October 10

Writers who are unsure where to start can send a single question to the club before the deadline. Everything else, from the rubric to the submission form, is available on the contest page.

§ Evaluation

Writers already know the scale before judging begins. Every article earns up to **one hundred points**, decided across six categories: scientific accuracy and conceptual understanding (30), physical reasoning and analysis (20), clarity, structure and communication (20), creativity and intellectual contribution (15), real-world connection (10), and research and references (5). Mentors and editors score each piece independently against the same scale, and participants receive brief editorial feedback as part of the experience.

Writing “ $F = ma$ ” on its own shows little. Explaining the law, applying it correctly, and noting its assumptions and limits shows real understanding.

§ Results and Awards

Medals go to the top 30% of participants in a Gold, Silver, and Bronze ratio of 3 to 2 to 1. The three strongest articles on the leaderboard receive special prizes, and everyone who enters receives a certificate that names the article and its writer. Results are announced on **October 10**, and the leaderboard appears on the contest page the same day.

§ Publication

Selected articles are gathered into a dedicated Physics Club Magazine issue for the wider school community to read, with each piece credited to its writer. The finished magazine stays available online so writers can share it, because the published issue is the real output of the competition, not just a ranking.

Share your writing voice with the Physics Club Magazine.